the refugee. However, in practice it became evident that it was migrants who – now empowered, also through social media, by international conventions and Western sense of individual rights – were determined not to accept the first entry rule and wanted to have a final destination of their own choice. Their expectations of what they are entitled to also run high. In addition, the UN-wide 1951 Refugee Convention, invoked also during this mass wave, put considerable pressure on recipient countries. Many governments (loudly or tacitly) felt that the Convention may have worked out in a post-World War II setting, where it was mostly about European refugees seeking safe havens, but was difficult to implement in conditions of large-scale immigration from outside Europe, often facilitated by human traffickers or third-state actors.

And then there was the cultural element – the will to generously accept masses of migrants or refugees seemed to be in tune with the Western idea of multicultural society, an idea largely unknown or at least untested in culturally much more homogenous Eastern European countries.

Western Europe faced the first modern challenges in the field of migration at the end of the nineteenth century (German annexation of Alsace, Polish workers, French 'integration' of the Basques and Bretons) and with the labour needs after World War I.[109] This need became even more acute after World War II, when a new element emerged, especially for Great Britain, France and the Netherlands – the arrival of people from their former colonies. For France, the most difficult case was Algeria, as Algerians were in fact its citizens or at least enjoyed the freedom of settlement in France. The same was true for British colonies in the Caribbean and India, and Dutch possessions in Indonesia. All of these countries primarily wanted to get labour from Europe, but – firstly as part of efforts to preserve overseas possessions and then in the process of decolonisation – they also had to agree to the arrival of non-European workers.

There was a significant complication in France, where Algerian workers were often seen as agents of the Algerian struggle for independence; the French public increasingly perceived them as a violent threat to France due to the terrorist acts during the 1960s. Some of the Indonesian immigrants also brought political divisions to the new-old homeland of the Netherlands. Nevertheless, employers' desire for cheap labour did not wane in France or elsewhere until the oil crisis in the early 1970s. It was during this period